PRAMIPEXOLE

Impulse-control disorders

Sudden sleep onset

CHEMICAL NAME (S)-N⁶-propyl-4,5,6,7-tetrahydro-1,3-benzothiazole-2,6-diamine (dihydrochloride monohydrate)

CLASS Non-ergot dopamine agonist

TRADE NAMES Mirapexin · Mirapex · Sifrol · Pexola

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Parkinson's disease (early monotherapy or adjunct to levodopa).
- Restless legs syndrome (low dose).

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** IR three times daily or PR once daily; titrate weekly.
- Doses expressed as base or salt — check (0.088 mg base = 0.125 mg salt).
- Taper when stopping.

DOSAGES

- **Parkinson's:** 0.088 mg base three times daily, increase weekly; usual up to 3.3 mg base/day.
- **Restless legs:** 0.088 mg base 2–3 h before bedtime (max 0.54 mg).
- **Renal impairment:** reduce frequency.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Peak:** 1–3 h. Bioavailability >90%.
- Minimal metabolism.
- Excreted unchanged in urine. **t½:** 8–12 h.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Agonist at **D2/D3 receptors** in striatum → improves motor symptoms; delays need for levodopa.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Nausea, dizziness, somnolence.
- Postural hypotension.
- Peripheral oedema.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Impulse-control disorders (gambling, hypersexuality, binge eating, shopping).
- Sudden sleep attacks.
- Hallucinations, confusion (elderly).
- Augmentation in restless legs; dopamine agonist withdrawal syndrome.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Hypersensitivity.
- **Caution:** psychosis, cardiovascular disease, renal impairment.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Antipsychotics, metoclopramide:** antagonism.
- **Cimetidine:** ↑ levels.
- **Sedatives, alcohol:** ↑ sleepiness.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Ask patients and carers specifically about impulsive behaviours.
- Monitor sleepiness, postural BP, hallucinations.
- Check renal function.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Report gambling, shopping, sexual urges or eating you cannot control.
- Do not drive if you have sudden sleep episodes.
- Rise slowly.
- Do not stop suddenly.

KEY POINTS

- Non-ergot D2/D3 agonist.
- Impulse-control disorders, sleep attacks.
- Parkinson's and restless legs.
- Renal excretion.

SOURCES CHECKED **[824]** Pramipexole 0.088 mg tablets (UK SmPC)

Full references p. 432–457